

1. We're going to need default hard budget caps on pretty much everything

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-03T23:34:02+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/3/default-hard-budget-caps/>

Here's a product feature which the world is going to need a whole lot more of over the coming months and years: default hard budget caps . I'm talking about the feature of pay-by-usage services and APIs that lets you say "after \$X/month, cut this thing off and return errors". These need to be hard limits. Soft caps, "after \$X/month, send me a warning email", will not cut it. Coding agents, and personal agents (coding agents wrapped in a less threatening UI), greatly reduce the friction of spinning up code that can do useful things. Sometimes those things cost money - calls to paid APIs, or hosted web applications, or systems that can bill for additional storage and compute. Nobody wants to wake up to an email sent at midnight warning about a budget limit and find that, while they slept, their rogue service had consumed several hundred (or several thousand) more dollars of usage. An argument against this is that businesses don't want their hosted applications to start throwing errors because some budget was exceeded. I expect that most businesses and individuals would prefer errors to a surprise \$10,000+ bill. I think hard budget caps need to be the default. If someone wants to liv...

2. September sponsors-only newsletter

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-03T22:00:31+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/3/newsletter/>

I just sent the September edition of my sponsors-only monthly newsletter . If you are a sponsor (or start a sponsorship now) you can access it here . This month: More Fable class models A pricing war 3D graphics, Blender, and pixel art LLMs come for mathematics So many more accidental cyberattacks The vulnapocalypse comes for Datasette What I'm using right now My software releases this month 2026 in LLMs (so far) Here's a copy of the August newsletter as a preview of what you'll get. Pay \$10/month to stay a month ahead of the free copy! Tags: newsletter

3. Rex's Dino Store

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-02T22:57:38+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/2/rex-s-dino-store/>

Museum: Rex's Dino Store Located just before the turnstiles in the Grand Army Plaza subway station at the north end of Brooklyn's Prospect Park is this former newsstand which is now operated by a dinosaur. The density of dinosaur puns is exceptional . Tags: art , new-york

4. WorkOS

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-03T21:23:10Z

Link: https://workos.com/guide/the-developers-guide-to-sso?utm_source=daringfireball&utm_medium=newsletter&utm_campaign=q32026

My thanks to WorkOS for sponsoring this last week, once again, at DF. SSO is table stakes for enterprise deals, but building it into your app yourself means writing SAML controllers, parsing XML assertions, and handling IdP-specific quirks for each provider. Learn how SAML flows work, the tradeoffs between building or buying, and best practices for security, routing, and UX. Or, skip the hassle and add SSO with WorkOS . Read their developer's guide to learn more ? everything from how SSO works to why WorkOS is the fastest way to add it. ?

5. Apple Confirms iPhone 18 Pro Max AT&T Cellular Issues, Affected Devices Require Hardware Replacement

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-03T18:21:14Z

Link: <https://9to5mac.com/2026/10/02/apple-confirms-iphone-18-pro-max-att-cellular-issues-affected-devices-require-hardware-replacement/>

Chance Miller, 9to5Mac: In a statement to 9to5Mac, Apple said: We have identified an issue

affecting a small number of iPhone 18 Pro Max users on the AT&T network that may cause a device to lose service and be unable to make calls. We released iOS 27.0.1 earlier this week and strongly encourage all iPhone 18 Pro Max users to update now, and are also issuing a carrier settings update today. These updates together are meant to help prevent this issue from occurring. The carrier settings update for the iPhone 18 Pro Max will download automatically over the next 14 days. However, users can manually trigger the download by going to Settings, choosing General, then About. Apple explains that the software updates will help prevent future issues for iPhone 18 Pro Max users on AT&T. The software updates will not restore service on devices that have already lost it. Apple says that iPhone 18 Pro Max users who have already lost service will need a hardware replacement. Those users should contact Apple Support or AT&T, or visit an Apple Store or AT&T location. As we reported this morning , iPhone 18 Pro Max users affected by this problem can't connect to AT&T's network for calls, texts, and d...

6. Duo-Man

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-28T16:35:02Z

Link: <https://x.com/viditb/status/2104103592726765722>

Vidit Bhargava (developer of LookUp and Movie Buzz): Duo-Man offers the complete walkman experience on the iPhone Duo. Open the Duo to pick and ?insert? the cassette, Close the Duo to start listening. Yes, I actually recorded the button clicks and static noise from a real Walkman! More like this, please. ?

7. Why is there no Windows hot-patching support for other architectures like 32-bit ARM and MIPS?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Fri, 02 Oct 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261002-00/?p=112753/>

They either predate hot-patching or never needed it. The post Why is there no Windows hot-patching support for other architectures like 32-bit ARM and MIPS? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. Shipping is the foundation

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sat, 03 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/shipping-is-the-foundation/>

There are lots of skills involved in being a successful engineer at a big tech company. Running effective meetings, writing good design docs, fleshing out tickets and epics, improving team processes, tech leading small groups of engineers, and so on. But all of these rest on the foundation of being able to ship. In Dota 2, the early game involves ?laning?: competing with an enemy player to collect resources from a small area. There are many, many strategies and considerations involved in laning. But the simplest possible approach is just to run at your opponent and attack them until they're forced to either run away or die. All the other laning strategies must solve that problem first, because it doesn't matter how well you play if you're forced out of the playing area. If you get that wrong, it doesn't matter how much else you get right. In Magic: the Gathering and Starcraft, many players adopt an ?aggro? strategy of building an attacking force as early as possible before the enemy player has time to construct a defense. That constrains the entire strategy space of the game, because it doesn't matter how clever your plan is if it loses to aggro every time. Even when there are no...

9. Why My Asus Laptop Kept Rebooting After Sleep and How to Fix it

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Sun, 04 Oct 2026 02:30:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/asus-laptop-keeps-rebooting-after-sleep>

Three years ago, I bought an Asus laptop, specifically the Zenbook Pro 17. It's a powerful machine and works just fine for my needs, but it had one problem that made me want to either return it or throw it out the window. I would work on projects for hours on end and close the lid when I was done. I haven't manually shut down a computer in more than 10 years. I only do so after a forced update or during a debugging session. So I would close the lid, and a couple

of hours later I would open it back up. Instead of waking from sleep, the computer would start from scratch as if it had been turned off and the battery was nearly dead. That meant everything I had open was closed. I'm lucky that most of the applications I run can restore a previous session, but it was extremely annoying. I had a similar issue with my previous Asus, and I had blamed Windows for it. The computer often woke from sleep just so Microsoft could perform an update, which used up all my battery. Sometimes I would open my backpack to find a dead laptop that was warm to the touch. I've written this blog post at least five times. Each time I thought I had solved the issue, but then it came back. This time, though, I...

10. Miquel's pivot theorem

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 03 Oct 2026 22:53:41 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/03/miquels-pivot-theorem/>

Euclidean geometry dates back at least to Euclid (circa 300 BC), and so you might think it's been pretty well picked over by now. And yet people still occasionally discover new plane geometry theorems. Some of these new theorems are complicated, asking question that the ancients would not have asked. But once in a while [?] The post Miquel's pivot theorem first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. This Week in Package Management: 3 October 2026

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-10-03T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/10/03/this-week-in-package-management.html>

Week twenty of the roundup, built from the package manager OPML feed collection and whatever I've posted or boosted on Mastodon . Releases mise 2026.10.0 requires keyless cosign bundles to match a pinned signer identity and stops GitHub attestation workflow checks accepting partial matches. 2026.9.18 added an include key that lets mise.toml pull a shared config fragment from a git repository or OCI registry, limited to tools, env, vars, hooks and aliases, with paranoid mode requiring a full commit sha or OCI digest. npm 12.2.0 accepts OIDC authentication for npm dist-tag , previously token-only. On the registry side, trusted publishing configurations now have an opt-in dist-tag permission , off by default, so a workflow can manage latest , next and similar tags without a long-lived token. pnpm 12.9 adds a per-registry networkConcurrency setting, records every installed project in the store, and stops pnpm login forwarding credentials in the request body to another origin on redirect. 12.8 warns when pnpm pack or pnpm publish would put a .env file in the tarball. RubyGems 4.0.22 keeps credentials on redirects only within the same origin. It also validates the version field in Gem::...

12. Reading List 2026-10-03

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 03 Oct 2026 13:14:44 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-2026-10-03>

A Senate permitting reform bill, the potential of Tesla's Cybercab, the Navy's \$200 billion worth of shipyard renovations, returning a SR-71 to service, and more.

13. Dyson CameraJet

Source: the singularity is nearer | Published: 2026-10-03T00:00:00+08:00

Link: <https://geohot.github.io/blog/jekyll/update/2026/10/03/dyson-camerajet.html>

So when I saw Dyson had a \$500 toothbrush , I was excited. Finally, advertising that targets me! I love brushing my teeth, and I have more money than I know how to spend. Not because I'm particularly rich, but because most stuff doesn't really appeal to me. Like if I owned a helicopter it would just be a headache, because like imagine one day I get a call from the hangar saying the hangar is flooding and the water is rising and you need to move your helicopter. I'm thousands of miles away and need a helicopter pilot in the next 30 minutes, a new place to store it, was the maintenance even done will we even be able to take off on short notice and really I just am upset with myself because I made the poor decision to purchase a helicopter, and once I come back to reality I feel relieved that I don't own a helicopter and this scenario will never happen to me. I do however, by means of my birthday, own a Dyson CameraJet (pictured above). It broke within 30 seconds of the first brushing. None of the LEDs

turn on anymore. I spent an hour investigating, finally opening the user removable battery compartment to find the Spearmint Dyson Low-foaming mouth rinse had leaked inside. And by how...

14. Connect Sony WH-1000XM3 on Arch Linux and a buggy UGREEN Bluetooth adapter

Source: Jayden?s Blog | Published: 2026-10-03T09:25:00+00:00

Link: <https://jayd.ml/2026/10/03/sony-headphones-action-bluetooth-adapter.html>

Tried to connect to my Sony WH-1000XM3 headphones on Arch Linux KDE, it would try and connect but fail with The setup of WH-1000XM3 failed . I have a UGREEN USB Bluetooth 5.3 Adapter adapter, which contains an Actions ATS2851 chipset. Apparently this is a known chipset quirk with Sony headphones and this adapter . Attempting to connect manually with bluetoothctl would just stall out: bluetoothctl]> scan bredr SetDiscoveryFilter success Discovery started [CHG] Controller F4:4E:FC:77:8F:36 Discovering: yes [NEW] Device 54:3A:D6:26:7A:E4 [TV] Samsung Q80AA 65 TV [NEW] Device CC:DE:AD:BE:EE:FF WH-1000XM3 [bluetoothctl]> scan off Discovery stopped [CHG] Device CC:DE:AD:BE:EE:FF RSSI is nil [CHG] Device 54:3A:D6:26:7A:E4 RSSI is nil [CHG] Controller F4:4E:FC:77:8F:36 Discovering: no [bluetoothctl]> pair CC:DE:AD:BE:EE:FF Attempting to pair with CC:DE:AD:BE:EE:FF [CHG] Device CC:DE:AD:BE:EE:FF Connected: yes [DEL] Device 54:3A:D6:26:7A:E4 [TV] Samsung Q80AA 65 TV [WH-1000XM3]> The Workaround This only happens when you do initial pairing. If you skip pair it apparently works. power off power on agent off agent KeyboardDisplay default-agent scan bredr (wait for headphones to appear) scan o...

15. Pluralistic: Economic probabilities for our grandchildren (03 Oct 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Sat, 03 Oct 2026 12:07:59 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/10/03/full-employment/>

Today's links Economic probabilities for our grandchildren: If only data centers would stop hogging all the copper. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: RIAA v P2P; Infoseek's anti-terror brain-scanner; Copyrighting every phone number; Carving pumpkins with cookie-cutters; Polish women go on strike; Latent labor in material world; Hitler's meth; "Flying Saucers Are Real!"; Hope, not optimism; Broadcast Flag talk; David Suzuki's free research; "Inquisitor's Apprentice"; California's tax ban made the rich MUCH richer; Union organizers caught Wells Fargo; Power poses aren't real; "Ghosts"; Criticizing tech; "Savage Love A-Z." Upcoming appearances: Brighton, Virtual, South Bend, Hudson, Calgary, Winnipeg, Paris, OVancouver, Victoria, Ottawa, Kilkenny, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Economic probabilities for our grandchildren (permalink) The post-war "peace dividend" owed its existence to three factors: industrial capacity, political freedom and pent-up demand. Industrial capacity: freed up by the war's end and the...